

It was a nasty day.

The weather was windy, and all the people seemed to walk only in the direction toward me, so I had to jump from side to side to avoid bumping into them and potentially staining my shoes. Of course, I had overslept that morning, and chances were I forgot something important like my key card — something I would only discover once I got to university.

Not a nice day, it was. Though worst of all – I had to stop my rushing jog as soon as I put my foot on the road and heard a beep. The traffic light showed red. The color of aggression and hostility.

It showed red as I steadied my breath. It showed red when I remembered how important today's class was. And, eventually, it continued its wicked game when my bus on the other side of the road came and went, leaving me behind.

It wasn't just one particular traffic light, no. Ever since our battle of wills started, I realized it wasn't just one that wanted to disrupt my life, but all of them.

There were times when I gained enough speed to feel warm in winter, but I had to halt at the traffic light and start shivering again. I had to endure these stopping points, while tired beyond belief or drenched in rain. Sometimes I came to the road and the traffic light showed yellow, but as soon as it saw me, it switched to that piercing red.

The only times this wretched thing showed a green light were when I was in a car or on a bus, rushing to some appointment or eager to get home after a long day. The green light for pedestrians, of course. And every time I was stuck in a vehicle, glued to the window and watching people who were completely unaware of their luck and free from traffic light sabotage.

The conflict seemed to have no resolution, as I had no power over the traffic lights, and they had all the power they wanted over my time. So, I let them.

And with acceptance, I decided that maybe such pauses were a good thing – a tiny breathing room amid the rush of the modern world.

And red turned neutral.